



### Neanderthal Hybrid Discovered

Scientists are stunned by the discovery of a skeleton that can rewrite human history as we know it.  
<https://digit.in/sep18-46-1>



### The story of NotPetya

The untold story of the deadliest cyberattack the world has ever witnessed  
<https://digit.in/sep18-46-2>



# Pre-order? No thank you!

Agent001 is nearly tempted to splurge on a brand spanking new graphics card.

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It's been two whole years since the last GPU family launch from NVIDIA and one since AMD made their move into the high-end desktop graphics market. NVIDIA certainly had the upper hand and AMD couldn't topple NVIDIA off the flagship pedestal. Suffice to say that it's been a while since we've seen a proper Team Red vs Team Green battle. If the wait thus far hasn't been excruciating on my mind then the sky-high prices of the graphics cards thanks to the mining craze did not help alleviate my frustration. There are many more sharing the same emotions as I so when news started to trickle about NVIDIA's Gamescom announcement, I was already excited.

Some early benchmarks from Chinese portals showed even more promise than I'd imagined and so I boarded the hype train. RSS feeds were set up and my search habits made Google's algorithms send more NVIDIA news right into my smartphone. Every morning there'd be some new claim, leak or fakery that'd add to the hype as well as the confusion. Even as the day of the announcement came around, the hype was still strong. A few AIB cards had leaked the previous day and I was

all the more excited to see how they perform in current gen games. A good marker was to see which generation NVIDIA compared it against. If the cards were good, NVIDIA would compare it against the previous generation i.e. the 10-series. If the cards were average, then NVIDIA would compare it against the 9-series to showcase a wider performance gap.

The keynote began and all the new features were being introduced one after the other. Even the cards had

nounced which made not just me but half the guys I was watching the livestream with, scratch their heads. The RTX 2080 Ti was priced at \$1,199 and that too with a month-long pre-order gap. Following the RTX 2080 Ti was the RTX 2080 at \$699 and RTX 2070 at \$599. These were ridiculous prices with no justifiable reason shown in the press-conference.

It took me a while to calm down and analyse the situation. The Ray Tracing features showcased during



\$400 on your left, \$1,199 on your right

been announced but none of the usual performance charts were shown. This was odd, extremely odd. Generally, NVIDIA just throws the performance graphs in your face but aside from just one obfuscated graph stating a 6x ray-tracing performance increase compared to the 10-series cards, there was no other meaningful metric shown. That's when the prices were an-

the keynote forms a massive step in the graphics technology evolution. At such an early state in the introduction of a product, such price premiums are a common occurrence. Then a demo video surfaced of Shadow of the Tomb Raider from the NVIDIA Gamescom booth in which the flagship RTX 2080 Ti was supposedly struggling to maintain more than 30 FPS. This looked